

Yeddanapudi Radhika

Every year, there is a spurt in the number of corporations that involve themselves in informational non-broadcast electronic media. Not all of today's information and news programs are for broadcast. In fact, many programs are produced for the corporate non-broadcast settings than in any other genre. You hear the terms: corporate television, industrial video, business television, closed-circuit television, private television—they are all synonyms

Web sites are among the more recent popular cost-saving applications. Video has been used for dissemination of information, about the company and its people, to familiarise vendors or sales channels with new products, to train staff or employees in new skills or procedures, to report new corporate developments or earnings to industry analysts or the media, and also to brief staff on recent company changes.

Video conferencing

Video conferencing has emerged as the best alternative to actual face-to-face meetings. By adding tone, voice and visual cues to the

Shoot Your Boss...

... and other colleagues using video techniques to train recruits, handle processes, create archives—And yes, save some money, too!

describing the business of informational non-broadcast electronic media.

The question is, why? What do they know that we don't? How do corporates use video technology?

Though corporates recognised the advantages of transmitting images, two factors inhibited its use: cost of production and delivery, and technical complexities. Production, in the past, did not use the desktop and needed specialised equipment and facilities. Similarly, delivery required special facilities—bandwidth, for example—at other locations in order to make broadcast possible. All of this came at a premium cost that made it unattractive to the corporate sector. An additional expense was the necessity of technically skilled personnel, such as video producers, Web masters and IT professionals.

Technologies converging towards the PC, reduction of costs, and an exponential increase in user-friendliness has generated immense corporate demand for stand-alone video products, or video in conjunction with print media. Compared to the cost of producing face-to-face meetings, events, training sessions or roadshows, the investment is actually small.

With branches spread all over a particular country, or even across continents, corporates find video a cost-effective communication tool to produce training videos, advertisement spots, sales and publicity material and staff orientation products. These can be directed at clients, employees, franchisees and partners. Video conferencing, and streaming video on



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